

Lab 7 Participant Workbook

Project Aurora: build, test and evaluate a live SharePoint dashboard with Copilot.

Lab ID	Duration	Tools & Technologies	Outcome
300	60-75 minutes	SharePoint, Lists, Copilot in SharePoint	Connected interactive HTML dashboard with verified controls

CASE OBJECTIVE

The IT PMO needs one live portfolio view. The list contains deliberate errors and incomplete evidence, so the dashboard must show both portfolio status and data quality.

Learning objectives

- Create a SharePoint list from an import-ready Excel table.
- Ask Copilot to inspect source quality before visualisation.
- Create and refine an interactive HTML report connected to the list.
- Validate KPI definitions and totals.
- Apply one controlled source-field change and verify its exact impact.
- Distinguish polished visual presentation from reliable management evidence.

Lab files

- Project Aurora SharePoint Import Data.xlsx or .csv
- Dashboard Validation Controls.xlsx
- SharePoint List Setup Guide.pdf
- Copilot Dashboard Prompt Card.pdf

Exercise 1: Create and verify the source list

- 1 Follow the Setup Guide and create IT Project Delivery Register.
- 2 Confirm 30 records and 20 source columns.
- 3 Verify number, currency, date and choice fields.
- 4 Do not correct the deliberate quality issues.

Completion check

Check	Expected
List name	IT Project Delivery Register
Records	30
Project IDs	IT-001 to IT-030
Source problems	Retained for the lab
Copilot button	Visible or trainer demonstration path selected

Exercise 2: Inspect before creating

- 1 Run prompt 1 from the Prompt Card.
- 2 Check whether Copilot identifies missing ownership, invalid financial data, conflicting status and stale updates.
- 3 Reject any suggestion that silently fixes a source value.
- 4 Compare its findings with Data Quality Review in the validation workbook.

REQUIRED FINDING

The source contains 10 project records with at least one deliberate quality flag. Several records contain more than one flag.

Exercise 3: Propose and create the dashboard

- 1 Run prompt 2 and review the proposed structure.
- 2 Confirm KPI definitions and missing-value rules before creation.
- 3 Approve only when the plan retains a visible data-quality warning.
- 4 Run prompt 3 to create the connected interactive HTML report.
- 5 Test filters, search, sorting and source links.

Required components

Component	Minimum features
KPI cards	Active, Red, over budget, late, stale, decisions required
Filters	Department, project manager, stage, RAG, decision required
Charts	RAG, stage, budget versus forecast, schedule variance
Exception table	ID, name, PM, RAG, variance, forecast date, issues, decision, last update
Governance	Source list, data date, Not confirmed treatment, quality warning

Exercise 4: Refine without changing the source

- 1 Run prompt 4.
- 2 Review the proposed dashboard-only changes.
- 3 Confirm Copilot will not edit the SharePoint list.
- 4 Apply the refinements.
- 5 Reopen IT-003, IT-018 and IT-029 from the exception table to confirm financial warnings remain visible.

Exercise 5: Validate the dashboard

- 1 Open Dashboard Validation Controls.xlsx.
- 2 Use the Control Totals sheet as the expected source.
- 3 Run prompt 5 and compare each dashboard value with the workbook.
- 4 If values differ, identify the field definition or excluded source records before editing anything.
- 5 Confirm the dashboard does not hide the blank RAG status or invalid forecast cost.

Measure	Expected before test
Total / active	30 / 27
Red / Amber / Green / blank	3 / 13 / 13 / 1
Over budget / late / stale	16 / 16 / 2
Decision required	15
Quality-flagged records	10
Approved budget	EUR 6,925,000

Exercise 6: Run the one-field controlled test

- 1 Run prompt 6 and confirm the predicted impact.
- 2 Change only IT-017 RAG Status from Amber to Red using Copilot direct edit when available.
- 3 If direct edit is unavailable, open IT-017 and change that single SharePoint field.
- 4 Refresh or reopen the dashboard.
- 5 Run prompt 8 and compare with One Field Test in the validation workbook.
- 6 Stop if any unrelated measure changes.

Exercise 7: Challenge the management story

- 1 Run prompt 9.
- 2 Reject a conclusion that treats the invalid negative forecast as trusted financial evidence.
- 3 Challenge Green status for IT-015 because the source also reports a 45-day delay.
- 4 Keep IT-012 decision ownership as Not confirmed.
- 5 Explain why the dashboard is useful even though management still needs human review.

Success criteria

- The report remains connected to IT Project Delivery Register.
- KPI definitions and totals reconcile with the validation workbook.
- Filters, search and exception links work.
- Missing and conflicting values remain visible.
- Only IT-017 RAG Status changes in the controlled test.
- Red changes from 3 to 4 and Amber from 13 to 12.
- No unrelated KPI changes.
- At least one unsafe management conclusion is rejected or qualified.

Reflection

Question	Answer
Which visual looked most convincing before you checked the source?	
Which data-quality issue had the greatest management impact?	
What should be corrected in the source and by whom?	
When would Power BI be a better solution than this report?	

Limitations and troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Copilot in SharePoint is missing	Use the trainer demonstration path; the preview may not have reached the tenant or site.
Interactive report command is unavailable	Do not manually create substitute HTML. Observe the demonstration and complete the validation exercise.
Wrong totals	Check field types, blank handling, filters and invalid values before changing the source.
Dashboard appears static	Reopen or refresh the report and confirm it was created from the list, not from a copied snapshot.
Source links do not open	Confirm the report uses actual list-item links and the viewer has permission.
Large list is slow	Use indexed columns and filtered views; SharePoint list-view thresholds may affect queries.
Dashboard looks polished but is misleading	Use the validation workbook and keep source warnings visible.
Need advanced models or governed enterprise analytics	Use Power BI rather than treating the HTML report as a full BI replacement.

Reference dashboard

The GitHub lab page ends with an interactive example showing one possible dashboard layout. It uses the same synthetic data but is not connected to your SharePoint tenant. Use it as a design target, not as proof that your dashboard is correct.